

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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GOD HIDING HIS SERVANTS

Isaiah 49:2 in the shadow of His hand HE HID ME. NIV

Our focus - Isaiah 49:2-3

2 He made my mouth like a sharpened sword, in the shadow of his hand he hid me; he made me into a polished arrow and concealed me in his quiver.

3 He said to me, "You are my servant, Israel, in whom I will display my splendor." NIV

GOD HIDES AND KEEPS HIS PEOPLE SAFE FROM THOSE WHO CONSPIRE AGAINST THEM.

Psalms 31:20 You hide them in the shelter of your presence, safe from those who conspire against them. You shelter them in your presence, far from accusing tongues. NLT

Psalms 64:2 Hide me from the secret counsel of the wicked; from the insurrection of the workers of iniquity: KJV

GOD HIDES HIS SERVANTS IN THE TIME OF TROUBLE.

Psalms 27:5 For in the time of trouble he shall hide me in his pavilion: in the secret of his tabernacle shall he hide me; he shall set me up upon a rock. KJV

It is clear that God hides his people to protect and keep them safe from their enemies.

But in this study, I would like to present to every believer that there are times when God prepares us and instead of using us immediately, he hides his servants for a time.

He hides us in his **quiver** which refers to a pouch that holds arrows to be used with a bow and so his servants are likened to arrows.

Arrows that are shaped, polished and smooth – and ready for us – BUT then he hides them. Hidden from being displayed from the public arena of Ministry.

MAYBE you have experienced this in your life – you are ready and eager to be used but held back and not fitted to God's bow and released.

In this study we will look at one of the ways that God deals with us as his servants – THAT HE HIDES THEM.

1. That he trains, prepares, refines (polishes) and equips them with skills ready for future service.
2. But he doesn't immediately use or release them into active service.
3. He HIDES them safely in a place that has been prepared specifically for that purpose. (a quiver)
4. And we will try to determine **WHY** God acts in this way and to **OBSERVE** the servant's differing responses and reactions to God HIDING THEM IN HIS QUIVER.



BIBLICAL FACT No 1.

That God does prepare and ready his servants through mentoring, training, correcting, directing and exposing them to the disciplines that are an integral part of service.

BIBLICAL FACT No 2.

Then after God has completed their preparation and readiness, he HIDES them. He does not immediately use them or release them into service.

BIBLICAL FACT No 3.

That when God hides anything, it is with a positive and constructive purpose in mind. He is always committed to doing what is good and right.

BIBLICAL FACT No 4.

God does not hide us in anger or displeasure or to punish, his intention is to prepare us and make us delighted TO BE who we are and who we REPRESENT – God's servants.

BIBLICAL FACT No 5.

God's hiding place for his servants is a **prepared one** where he continues to care and watch over. The servant is not neglected or forgotten, although some measure of loneliness is experienced by the servant.

BIBLICAL FACT No 6.

The Servants anxiousness to serve

Their eagerness to serve God is a normal and natural response of every believer after accepting Christ as Saviour and Lord and is a very good desire **but being overanxious** about something can easily **lead to impatience and an inability to wait for God to direct** and do what he desires in our situation.

Anxiousness that is unchecked leads to impulsive action and the making of poor decisions; therefore, we should proceed slowly, carefully and always guided by God's advice.

Also, if God's people's anxiousness to serve remains unchecked with a clear understanding of God's Ways, the way he does things then it will lead to frustration, disappointment and discouragement.

God's ways are clearly defined in his written Word and are always consistent with his character and his person.

Israel knew of the mighty acts of God – but God showed Moses his ways.

Psalms 103:7 He made known His ways [of righteousness and justice] to Moses, His acts to the children of Israel. AMP

BIBLICAL FACT No 7.

This action of God preparing, training and refining his servants and then hiding them in his "quiver" until he is ready to fit them to his "bow" and send them on their way towards the objective/target that God has determined still takes place today.

This is because God knows that a servant must be appropriately prepared – the right temperament and suited for the field of service and its people there.

God wisely makes those choices for us before he commissions and sends us on our way.

BIBLICAL FACT No 8.

Let us understand that God hiding us in his quiver is a clear expression of God's care and concern for us so that we will be successful and fruitful in those things that he is sending us to do for him.

Let us submit to his ways because we acknowledge he knows best for us.

Amen - Ps Barry